



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt
Department of Justice

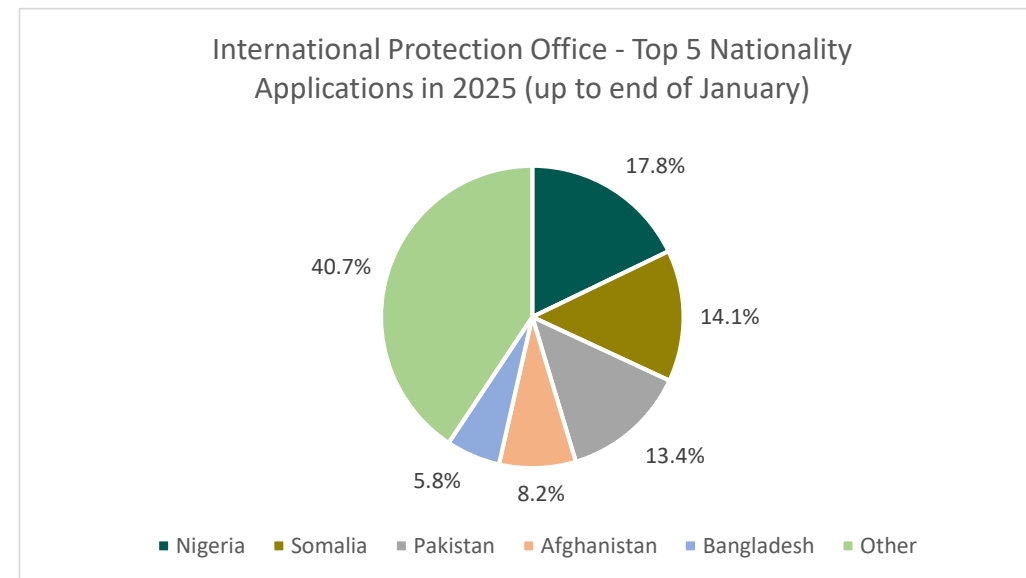
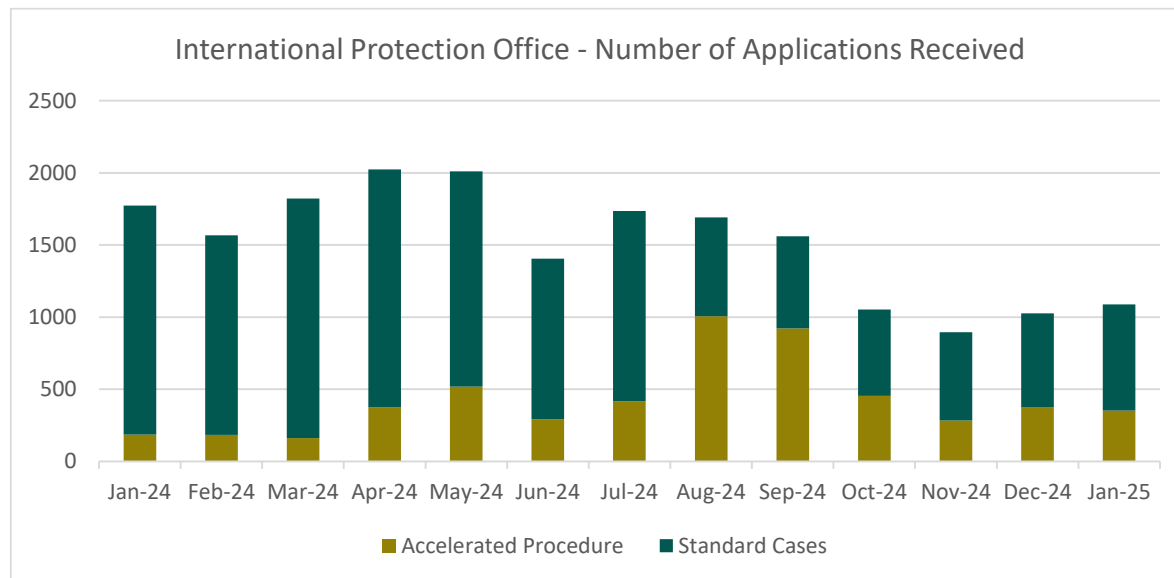
International Protection: January 2025

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 10th February 2025. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for January 2025:

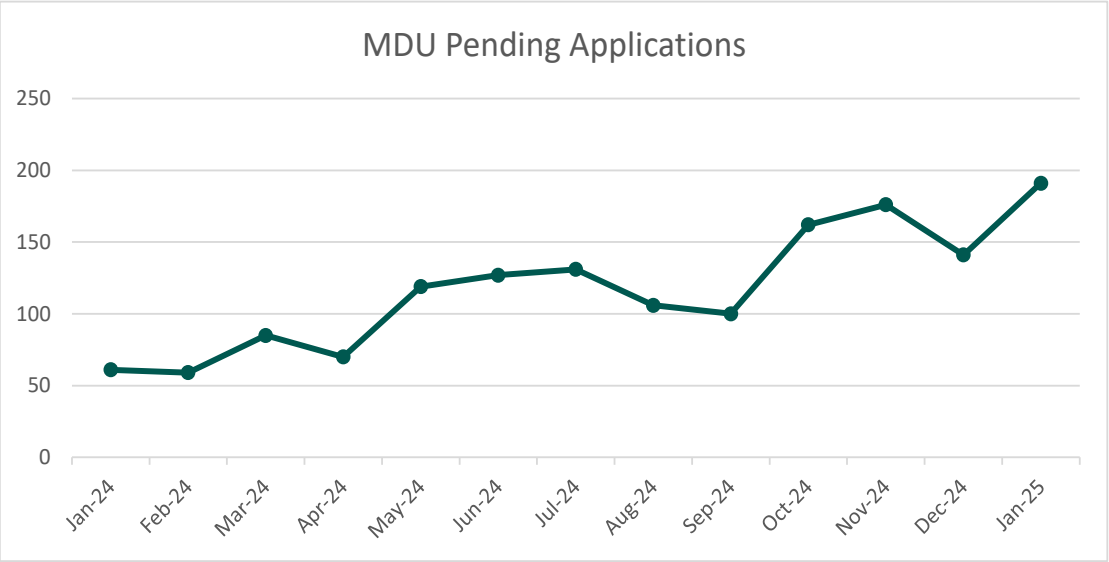
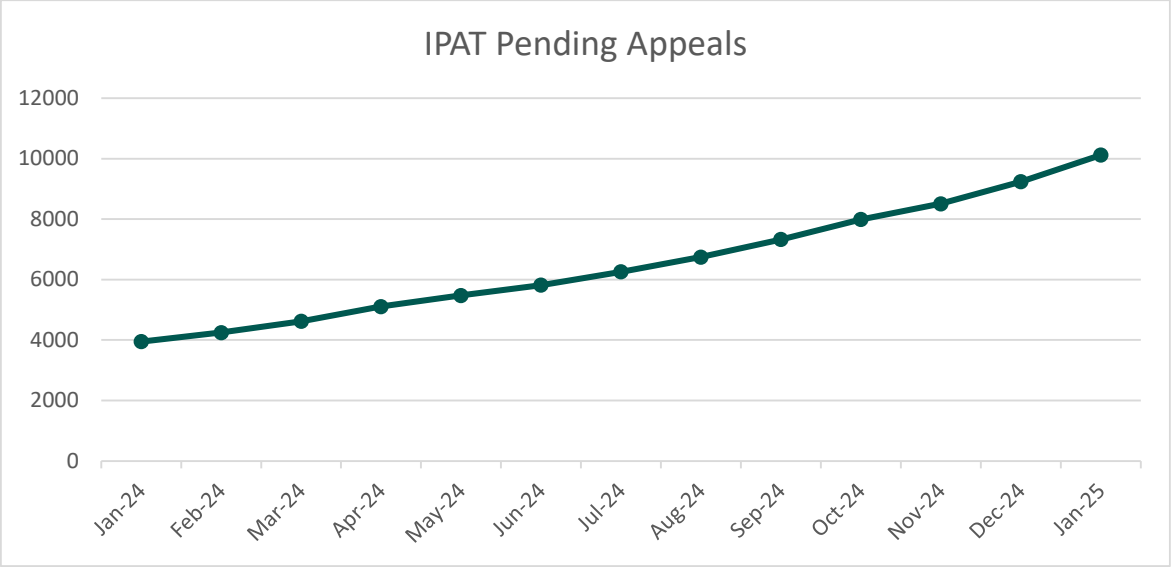
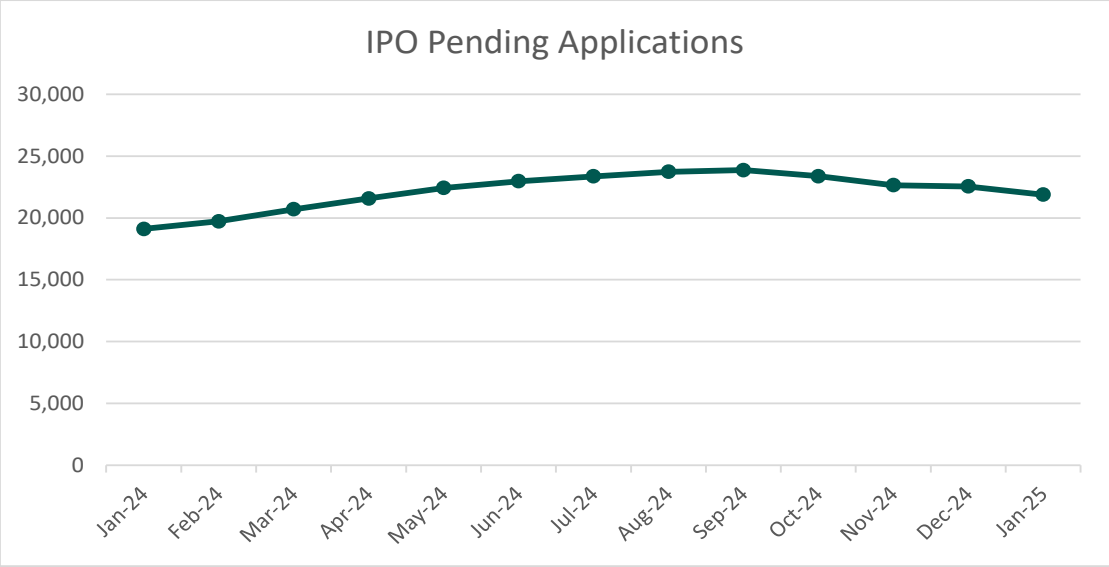
- The number of asylum applications is trending down. In January 2025 there were 1,087 applications received for asylum. This is down from 1,774 last January
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Nigeria (194 applications), Somalia (153), Pakistan (146), Afghanistan (89) and Bangladesh (63)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO is beginning to reduce since October 2024. As of January this year there were 21,882 applications pending
- The number of applications in the IPO where a recommendation has been made or otherwise closed off has increased in January 2025, where 1,780 cases were closed off
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases has begun to trend slowly upwards again, after having shown a downward trend between May 2024 and August 2024. In January 2025 the median processing time to determination was 82 weeks (compared to 79 weeks in July 2024 and 85 weeks in October 2024)
- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing, up to 593 at the end of January 2025
- Of those applications where a decision was made in January 2025 by MDU, 61% of decisions were refusals, 4% permission to remain, and 35% were international protection grants

Applications and Main Nationalities



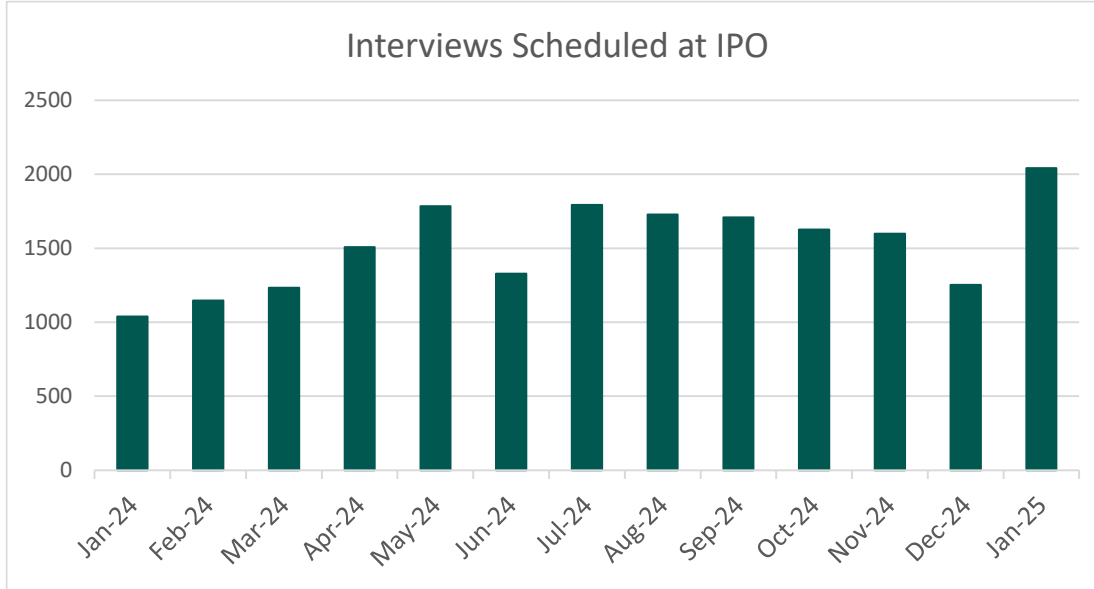
- In January there were 1,087 applications received for asylum. This is down from 1,774 last January. The average number of applications per month between February 2024 and January 2025 was 1,489
- For January 2025, the total number of applications included 352 from accelerated procedure (32% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Nigeria (194 applications), Somalia (153), Pakistan (146), Afghanistan (89) and Bangladesh (63)

Pending International Protection Applications

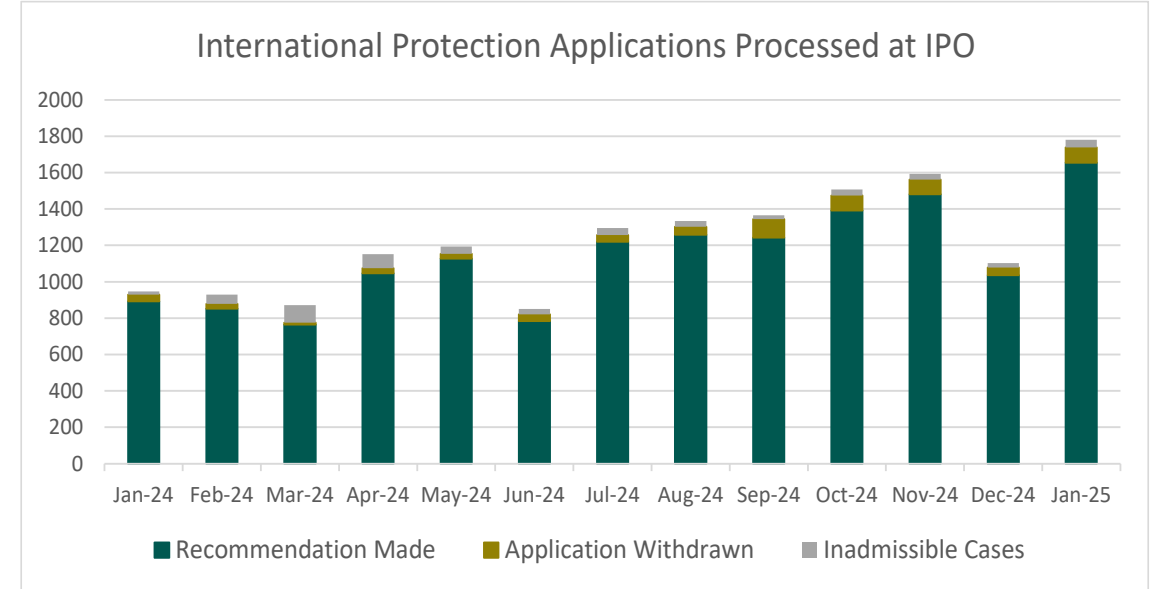


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 21,882. The numbers have begun to reduce since October 2024 (23,373)
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards. In January 2025, there were 10,125 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of January 2025 is 191

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

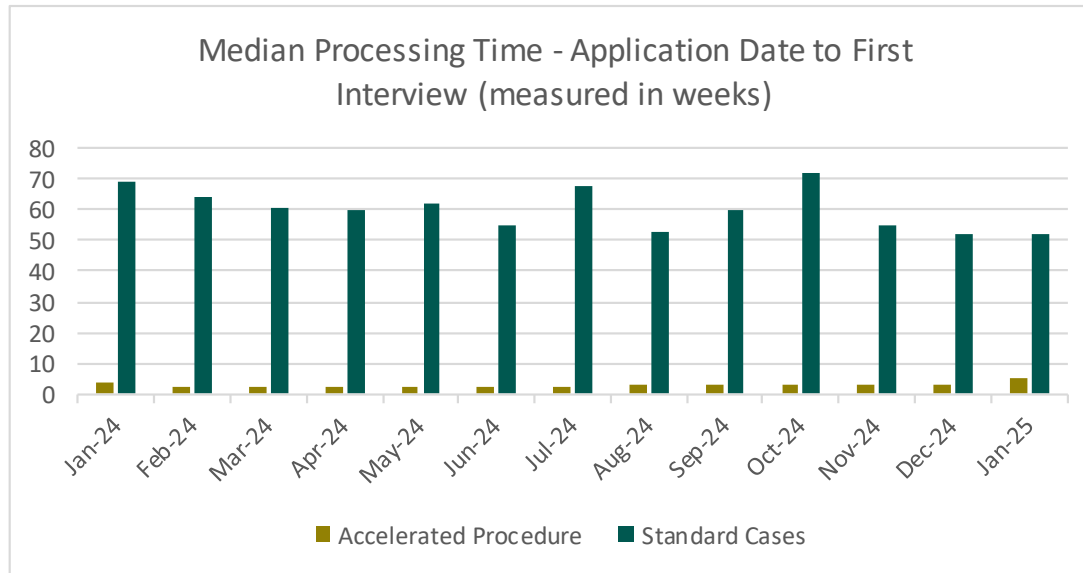


- The number of interviews scheduled at the IPO had been trending down since July 2024, but has shown a marked increase in January 2025
- In January 2025, there were 2,043 interviews scheduled, up from 1,598 in November 2024 and 1,252 in December 2024
- 2025 YTD interviews scheduled were 2,043 (a 96.8% increase on 1,038 interviews scheduled for 2024 YTD)

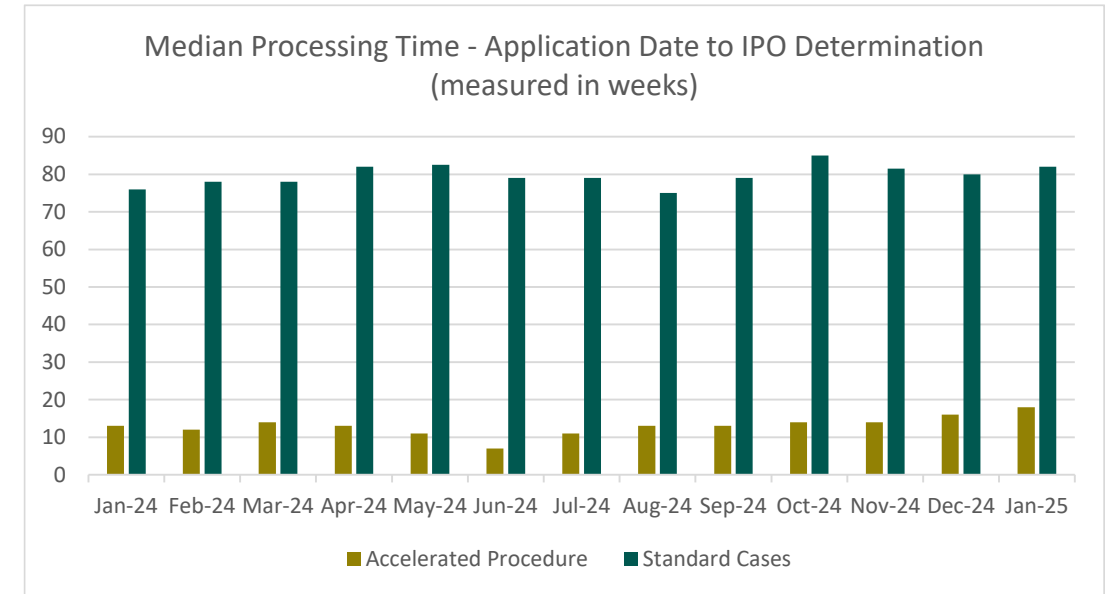


- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible and Applications Withdrawn
- In January 2025, 1,780 cases were closed off. This is up from 1,593 in November 2024 and 1,102 in December 2024
- 2025 YTD applications processed were 1,780 (an 88.2% increase on 946 applications processed for 2024 YTD)

International Protection Applications Processing Times

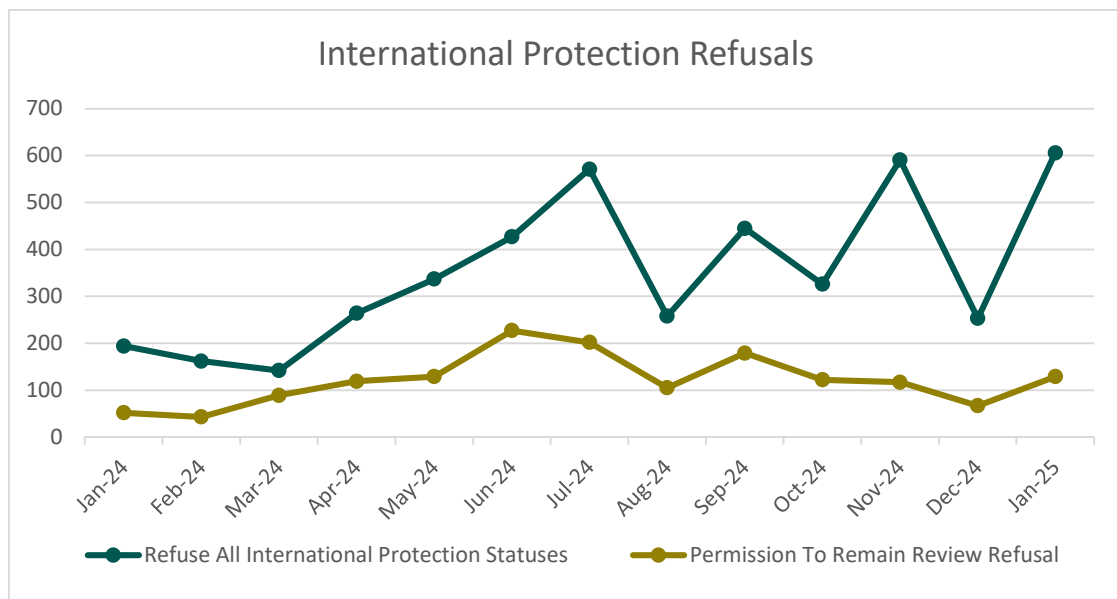
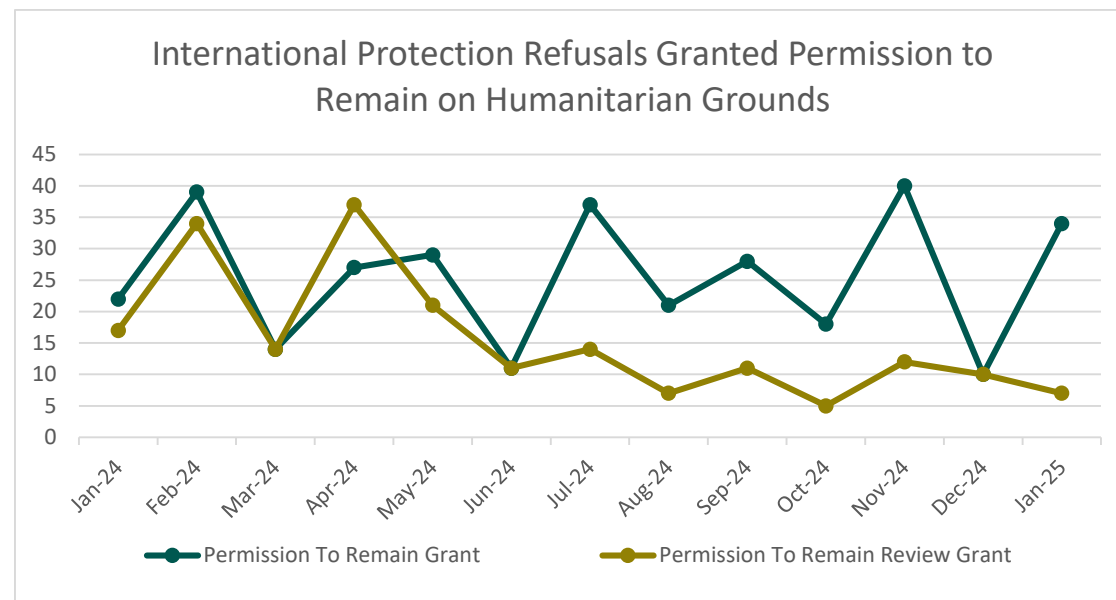
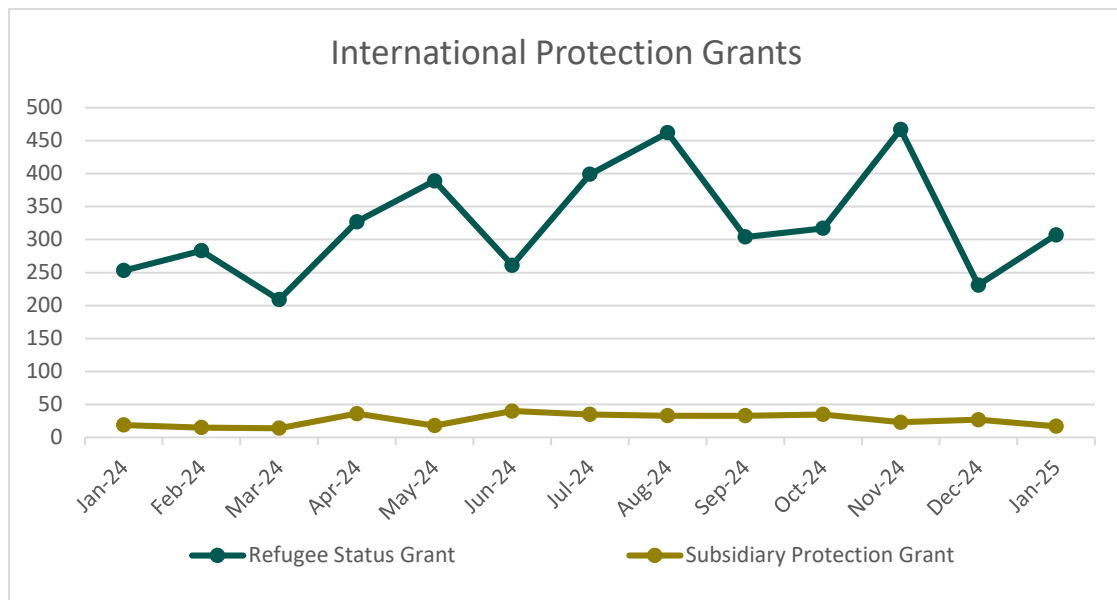


- Processing times are measured as a median. This represents the middle number in the range of times at hand for processing. The reason why the average is not used is that there are a handful of cases where processing times are long – this would disproportionately impact the average figure and not give a proper representation of processing time
- The median time to the first interview is generally trending downwards. In January 2025, it was 52 weeks for standard cases, down from 55 weeks in November 2024 and the same as 52 weeks in December 2024
- For accelerated procedure only cases, the waiting time to the first interview for January 2025 was 5 weeks, up from 3 weeks in November and December 2024



- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been slowly increasing since September 2024
- In January 2025, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 82 weeks (up from 81.5 weeks for November 2024 and 80 weeks for December 2024)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 18 weeks in January 2025, up from 14 weeks in November 2024 and 16 weeks in December 2024

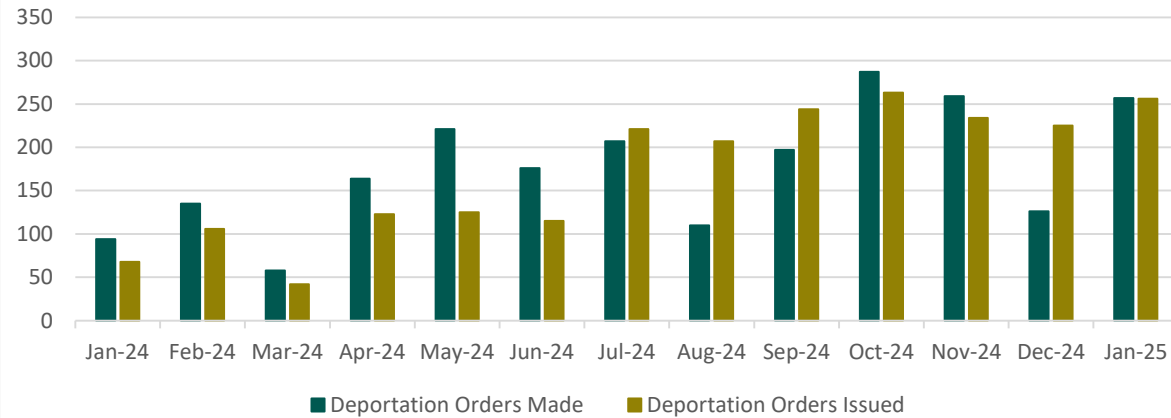
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In January 2025, of those applications where a decision was made, 307 were given refugee status grant and 17 subsidiary protection grant (324 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 34 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 7 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 606 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 129 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall for January 2025, 61% of decisions were refusals, 4% permission to remain, and 35% were international protection grants

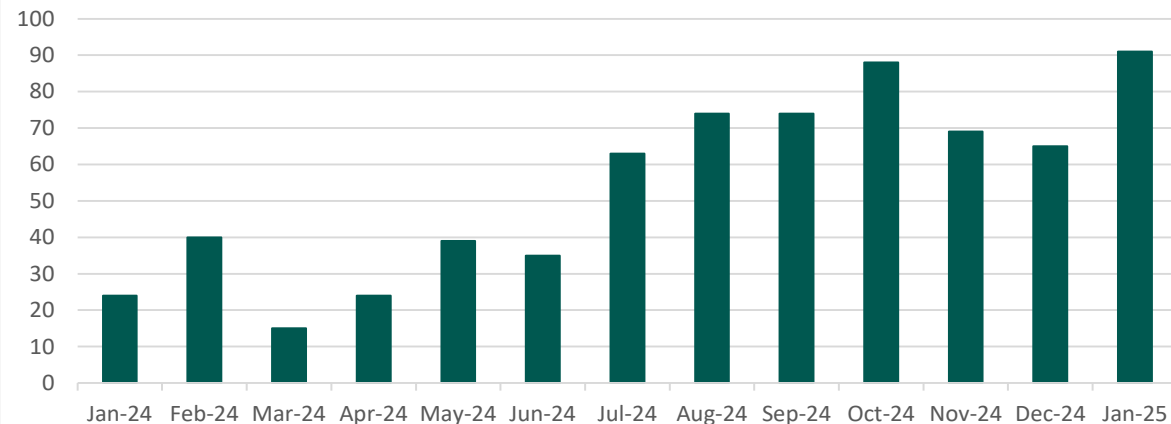
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

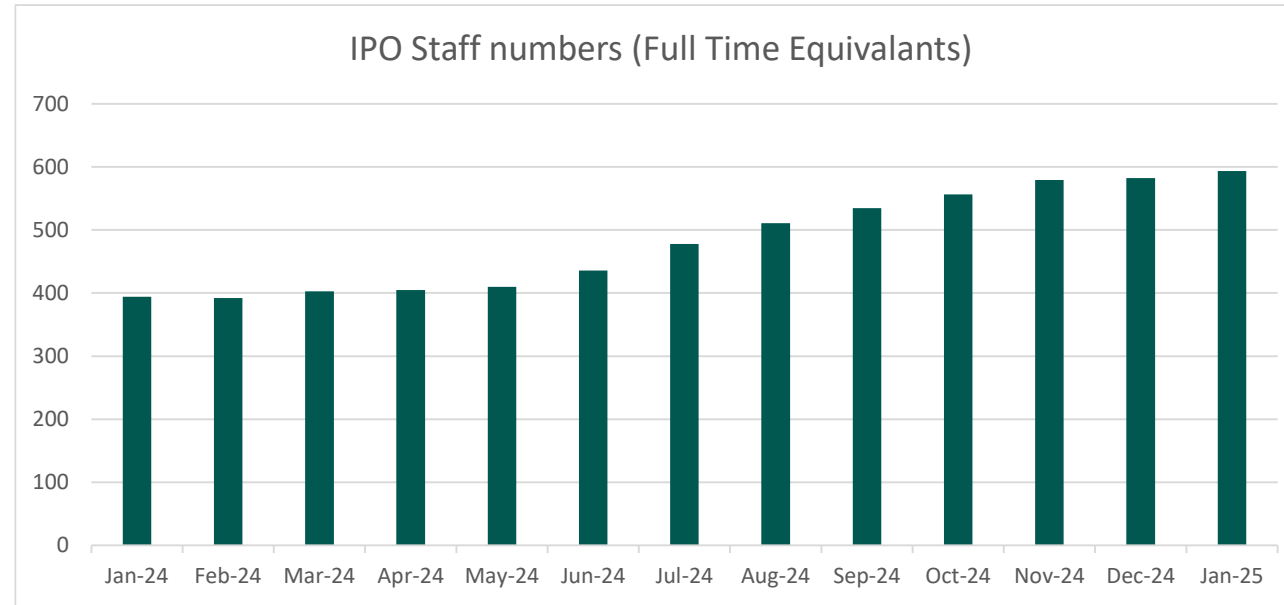


- For January 2025 the number of deportation orders signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 257 and the number of deportation orders issued was 256. For December 2024, the figures were 126 and 225, and for November, it was 259 and 234, respectively
- For January 2025 the number of removals was 91

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing
- In January 2024 there were 394 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards, to 478 in July 2024 and 556 in October 2024
- At the end of January 2025, the IPO had 593 FTE staff



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

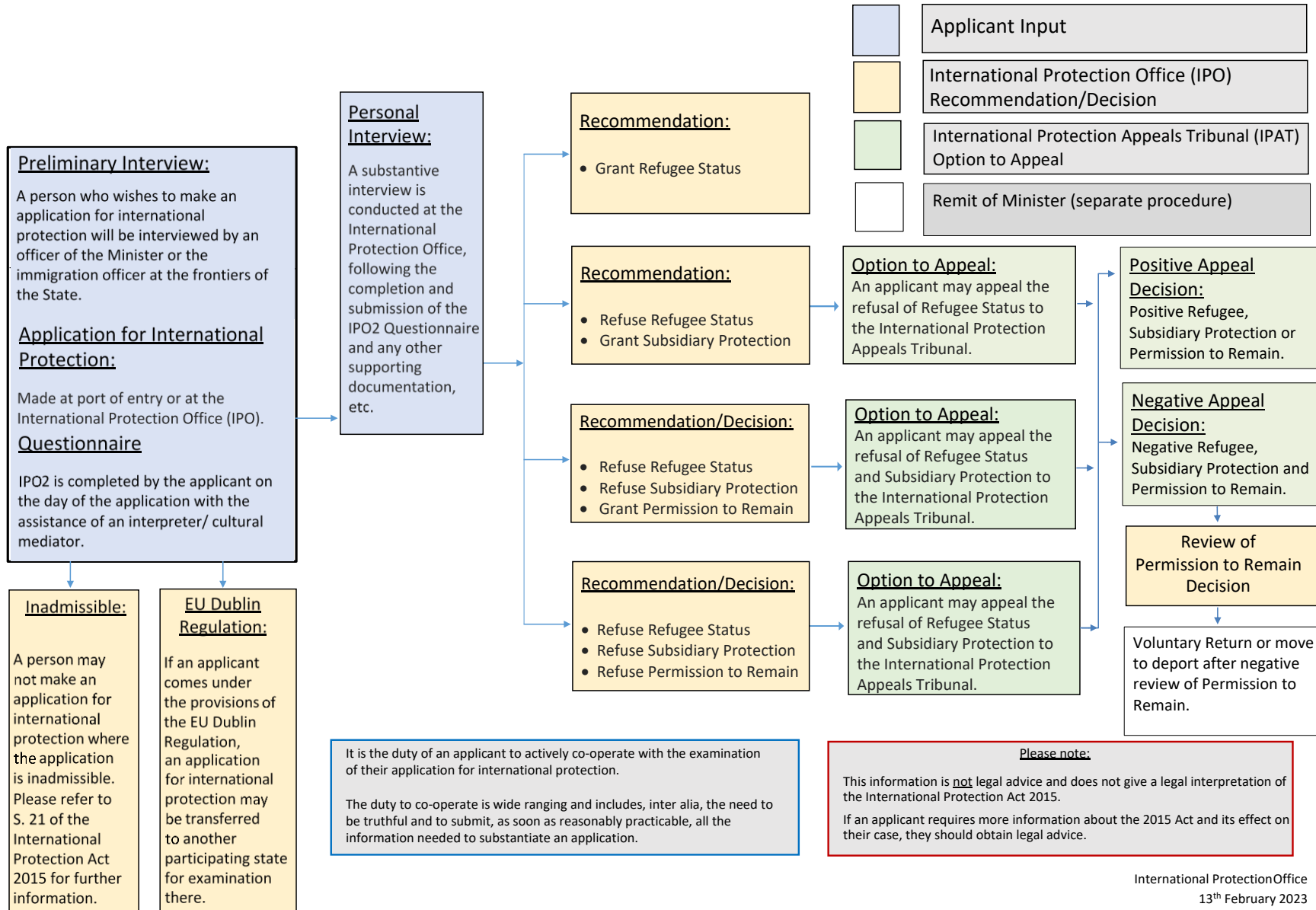
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25
Accelerated Procedure	186	183	162	374	518	292	417	1006	922	453	282	377	352
Standard Cases	1588	1384	1659	1649	1492	1112	1318	686	638	599	614	649	735

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2025 to date	Applications	%
Nigeria	194	17.8%
Somalia	153	14.1%
Pakistan	146	13.4%
Afghanistan	89	8.2%
Bangladesh	63	5.8%
Other	442	40.7%
Total	1087	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25
IPO Pending	19,109	19,719	20,695	21,577	22,419	22,965	23,360	23,727	23,863	23,373	22,641	22,548	21,882

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25
IPAT Pending	3949	4251	4620	5110	5478	5821	6257	6748	7331	7990	8513	9243	10125

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25
MDU Pending	61	59	85	70	119	127	131	106	100	162	176	141	191

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Interview Scheduled

	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25
Interviews Scheduled	1038	1148	1233	1509	1784	1329	1794	1728	1710	1626	1598	1252	2043

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25
Recommendation Made	892	853	765	1047	1128	784	1220	1258	1243	1391	1481	1036	1654
Application Withdrawn	37	25	10	28	25	36	36	44	101	83	81	43	84
Inadmissible Cases	17	51	97	77	40	30	40	32	21	33	31	23	42

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to First Interview (measured in weeks)

	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25
Accelerated Procedure	4	2	2	2	2	2	2	3	3	3	3	3	5
Standard Cases	69	64	60.5	60	62	55	68	53	60	72	55	52	52

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25
Accelerated Procedure	13	12	14	13	11	7	11	13	13	14	14	16	18
Standard Cases	76	78	78	82	82.5	79	79	75	79	85	81.5	80	82

Data Tables (5)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25
Refugee Status Grant	253	283	209	327	389	261	399	462	304	317	467	231	307
Subsidiary Protection Grant	19	15	14	36	18	40	35	33	33	35	23	27	17
Permission to Remain Grant	22	39	14	27	29	11	37	21	28	18	40	10	34
Permission to Remain Review Grant	17	34	14	37	21	11	14	7	11	5	12	10	7

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	194	162	142	264	337	427	571	258	445	326	591	253	606
Permission to Remain Review Refusal	52	43	89	119	129	227	202	105	179	122	117	67	129

Data Tables (6)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25
Deportation Orders Made	94	135	58	164	221	176	207	110	197	287	259	126	257
Deportation Orders Issued	68	106	42	123	125	115	221	207	244	263	234	225	256

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25
Enforcements/Returns*	24	40	15	24	39	35	63	74	74	88	69	65	91

Data Tables (7)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25
IPO Staffing Level	394.1	392.1	402.85	404.85	409.7	435.7	477.7	510.7	534.3	556.3	579.1	582.1	593.4